

WEEKLY ETF REVIEW

Tuesday, 14 July 2026

Investor Report

This report is for informational and educational purposes only; please see the disclaimer at the end.

PRIMARY REGIME

Risk-on growth

GEOPOLITICAL REGIME

Elevated but localized

MAIN TAKEAWAY

SMH remains the best-supported core exposure, but fresh capital and replacement decisions must clear price, relative-strength and portfolio-discipline gates.

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PORTFOLIO ACTION SNAPSHOT

DECISION COCKPIT

- This week: no portfolio action.
- Main active risk: SMH concentration remains above the soft position cap.
- Main active reviews: SPY versus SMH overlap, PAVE versus GRID, and GSG hedge-role validation.
- Next action trigger: a replacement candidate must show confirmed relative-strength edge, clean pricing basis, thesis fit, and a clear funding source.
- Fresh capital: blocked for positions under size or replacement review unless a future run clears the discipline gates.

Recommendation	Tickers / notes
Add / destination	None

Recommendation	Tickers / notes
Hold	SMH , DFEN , XLU , CIBR , GSG , IEFA , URNM
Hold with override	PAVE , SPY
Reflected replace / reduce	None
Close	None

ROTATION EXECUTION STATUS

- Guarded model rotation is already reflected in the official portfolio state and trade ledger; this run performed no duplicate state or ledger mutation.

BEST REPLACEMENTS TO FUND

- No challenger is promoted to a fundable replacement yet. Each named replacement must first clear the same close-date pricing basis and relative-strength duel.



REGIME DASHBOARD

Macro regime

- Current regime: Risk-on growth.
- Confidence: 66%.
- Deterministic regime read — review-only: The shadow engine currently classifies the backdrop as Risk-on growth, broadly aligned with the legacy regime read. Confidence is high but review-only, reflecting evidence consistency rather than a forecast. This does not authorize portfolio changes. The normal discipline gates remain decisive.
- Regime memory: Risk-on growth has persisted for 61 run(s); transition state is stable, breadth is mixed, and cross-asset confirmation is mixed.
- Decision rule: Do not rotate aggressively unless a regime shift persists for at least two runs or cross-asset confirmation becomes broad.

Policy and geopolitical status

- Status: Elevated but localized.

- Fed stance: Restrictive / data-dependent. Portfolio read-through: Prefer quality, profitable growth and cash discipline over weak balance-sheet beta.
- ECB stance: Tightening / inflation-sensitive. Portfolio read-through: [IEFA](#) exposure is now present, but further non-U.S. developed allocations still require relative-strength, pricing and portfolio-discipline confirmation.

What changed

- AI / semiconductor leadership remains the dominant equity impulse.
- Commodity-breadth hedge behavior remains under review rather than automatic ballast.

Portfolio implications

- Risk appetite is supportive, but fresh adds still need position-size room and pricing confirmation.
- Growth and infrastructure lanes can be considered if they do not worsen concentration.
- Defensive hedges should be reviewed for opportunity cost.

Policy catalysts included in this report

- ECB rate-policy tightening: The ECB raised rates this week in response to renewed inflation pressure; this raises the hurdle for rate-sensitive and non-U.S. developed-market exposure but does not override pricing, relative-strength or portfolio-discipline gates.
- AI infrastructure and semiconductor supply chains: Capital spending and strategic supply-chain policy continue to support semiconductor and infrastructure lanes.
- Defense and sovereign resilience: Defense-budget durability remains a structural support, but ETF vehicle choice still matters.

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STRUCTURAL OPPORTUNITY RADAR

Theme	Primary ETF	Alternative ETF	Why it matters	Structural fit	Macro timing	Status	What needs to happen	Time horizon
Cybersecurity resilience	CIBR	BUG	Cyber spend is linked to AI, cloud, data-center and geopolitical resilience.	4	4	Actionable now	Offers digital-infrastructure exposure with less direct semiconductor cyclicality.	3-12 months

Theme	Primary ETF	Alternative ETF	Why it matters	Structural fit	Macro timing	Status	What needs to happen	Time horizon
AI compute infrastructure	SMH	SOXX	Semiconductor and AI capex remains the cleanest funded structural growth lane. Macro filter: Regime and price leadership still support AI compute exposure, but concentration discipline applies.	5	5	Structurally actionable, but no fresh capital while above cap	AI infrastructure leadership remains persistent, but position-size discipline matters.	3-12 months
Biotech innovation / therapeutic platforms	XBI	IBB	Biotech remains a long-duration innovation lane but needs risk appetite.	4	3	Watchlist / under review	Can become attractive if breadth improves and rates ease.	3-12 months
Healthcare quality and defensive growth	XLV	VHT	Healthcare quality can provide defensive growth without speculative biotech beta.	3	3	Watchlist / under review	More useful if broad equity leadership narrows further.	3-12 months
Grid buildout / electrification	PAVE	GRID	Power demand, grid bottlenecks and reshoring capex support infrastructure spend. Macro filter: AI power demand and infrastructure policy support the grid lane; funding still depends on PAVE -vs- GRID duel evidence.	5	4	Watchlist / under review	PAVE remains useful, but GRID is the cleaner thematic challenger.	3-12 months
Power infrastructure and utilities capex	XLU	VPU	AI data-center power demand can also support regulated utilities and transmission spend.	3	3	Watchlist / under review	Offers a more defensive grid-adjacent expression if cyclical weakens.	3-12 months

Best structural opportunities not yet actionable

- Food security / agriculture inputs
- Water infrastructure / treatment
- Critical minerals / copper / refining

Notable lanes assessed but not promoted this week

Theme	Primary ETF	Why not promoted	What would change that
Financial infrastructure and market plumbing	KCE	Scored below the live radar cutoff versus stronger funded and challenger lanes.	Useful diversifier if financial infrastructure earnings broaden.
Agricultural commodities	DBA	Scored below the live radar cutoff versus stronger funded and challenger lanes.	Useful only if commodity stress becomes visible.
Defense innovation / sovereign resilience	PPA	Scored below the live radar cutoff versus stronger funded and challenger lanes.	The lane remains relevant, but PPA must justify itself versus ITA .
Non-U.S. developed market diversification	IEFA	Scored below the live radar cutoff versus stronger funded and challenger lanes.	Becomes fundable if U.S. factor concentration rises or non-U.S. breadth improves.

Theme	Primary ETF	Why not promoted	What would change that
Fintech / payments rails	FINX	Scored below the live radar cutoff versus stronger funded and challenger lanes.	Needs transaction-growth leadership and better price action.

4A. Short Opportunity Radar

Short theme	Candidate ETF	Short thesis	Trigger	Invalidation	Time horizon	Confidence
Rate-sensitive small caps	IWM	Restrictive real rates pressure weaker balance sheets.	IWM breaks down versus SPY while yields firm.	Clear easing impulse and better credit breadth.	1-3 months	Medium
China platform beta	KWEB	Policy confidence remains fragile.	Failed rally or renewed FX/policy stress.	Durable stimulus and earnings recovery.	1-3 months	Medium
Long-duration bonds	TLT	Sticky inflation and real-rate risk remain headwinds.	Real yields rise again.	Growth scare and decisive lower-yield breakout.	1-3 months	Medium
Speculative clean-tech beta	ICLN	Financing pressure and weak profitability remain issues.	Failure to recover in broad risk-on tape.	Sharp rate relief or major policy surprise.	3-12 months	Medium

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KEY RISKS / INVALIDATORS

- [SPY](#) plus [SMH](#) creates high U.S. tech / AI factor overlap.
- Hedge and defensive sleeves must justify their capital allocation through role validity, pricing and relative-strength evidence.
- [PPA](#) and [PAVE](#) remain replaceable until their ETF implementation quality is proven.
- Non-U.S. developed exposure has been increased through [IEFA](#), but breadth and relative-strength confirmation remain required.

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BOTTOM LINE

- **What should be exited first:** Determined by the rotation plan when active; otherwise no close is executed by legacy state.
- **What deserves additional capital first:** [SMH](#) remains the best-ranked funded lane, subject to the max-position rule.
- **What is acceptable but replaceable:** Holdings with high release scores require reduce/replace/override discipline.
- **Single best portfolio upgrade this week:** Use the rotation artifact as the bridge between evidence and target weights.

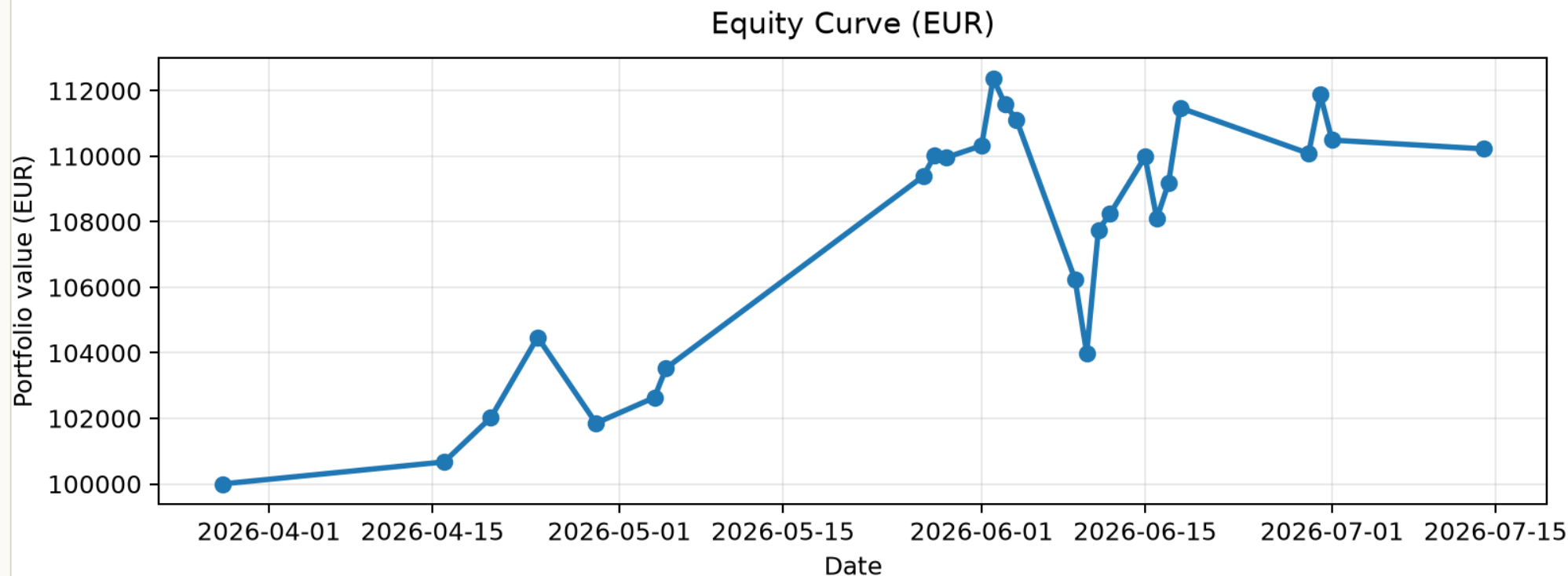


EQUITY CURVE AND PORTFOLIO DEVELOPMENT

- Starting capital (EUR): 100000.00
- Current portfolio value (EUR): 110224.85
- Since inception return (%): 10.22
- Equity-curve state: Reconciled to Section 15 with full valuation history
- EUR/USD used: 1.1421
- Notes: Section 7 uses the validated valuation history plus the current portfolio NAV; Section 15 is rendered from the same reconciled portfolio state.

Date	Portfolio value (EUR)	Comment
2026-03-28	100000.00	Inaugural model portfolio established
2026-04-16	100671.75	Fresh per-ticker repricing using latest completed close set
2026-04-20	102026.08	Fresh six-of-six repricing using completed 20 April close set
2026-04-24	104477.54	Partial fresh repricing using latest verified marks
2026-04-29	101854.68	Fresh six-of-six repricing using persisted 2026-04-29 audit
2026-05-04	102636.85	Partial pricing recovery using latest verified marks
2026-05-05	103536.96	Latest 4 May close basis; +8 SMH from cash
2026-05-27	109387.17	Runtime valuation from immutable pricing audit and explicit portfolio state
2026-05-28	110032.93	Runtime valuation from immutable pricing audit and explicit portfolio state
2026-05-29	109964.97	Runtime valuation repriced from official portfolio-state shares
2026-06-01	110321.58	Runtime valuation repriced from official portfolio-state shares
2026-06-02	112376.10	Runtime valuation repriced from official portfolio-state shares
2026-06-03	111596.95	Runtime valuation repriced from official portfolio-state shares
2026-06-04	111105.47	Runtime valuation repriced from official portfolio-state shares
2026-06-09	106246.36	Runtime valuation repriced from official portfolio-state shares
2026-06-10	103994.26	Runtime valuation repriced from official portfolio-state shares

Date	Portfolio value (EUR)	Comment
2026-06-11	107747.59	Runtime valuation repriced from official portfolio-state shares
2026-06-12	108243.33	Runtime valuation repriced from official portfolio-state shares
2026-06-15	109983.62	Runtime valuation repriced from official portfolio-state shares
2026-06-16	108100.61	Runtime valuation repriced from official portfolio-state shares
2026-06-17	109172.83	Runtime valuation repriced from official portfolio-state shares
2026-06-18	111477.30	Runtime valuation repriced from official portfolio-state shares
2026-06-29	110086.49	Runtime valuation repriced from official portfolio-state shares
2026-06-30	111878.25	Runtime valuation repriced from official portfolio-state shares
2026-07-01	110493.44	Runtime valuation repriced from official portfolio-state shares
2026-07-14	110224.85	Latest portfolio valuation based on confirmed closing prices and current holdings



Holding	Requested close	Close date used	Close used	Currency	Market-data source	Status
SMH	2026-07-14	2026-07-14	600.31	USD	Twelve Data	Fresh exact close, unverified
SPY	2026-07-14	2026-07-14	751.83	USD	Twelve Data	Fresh exact close, unverified
URNM	2026-07-14	2026-07-14	51.59	USD	Twelve Data	Fresh exact close, unverified
XLU	2026-07-14	2026-07-14	45.69	USD	Twelve Data	Fresh exact close, unverified

FX basis	Requested date	Date used	Rate	Source	Status
EUR/USD	2026-07-14	2026-07-14	1.1421	Twelve Data	Fresh exact close, unverified

7A. ETF Position Performance

Performance is calculated on the current ETF holdings using the latest validated close-price audit, available market-history inputs and, where needed, executed model-trade history.

Portfolio sleeve	Investment thesis	Tradable ETF	Weight %	1w return	1m return	3m return	Since-entry	P/L EUR	Contribution %
Rotation destination	Cybersecurity resilience	CIBR	19.11%	+1.10%	+8.70%	+47.71%	+2.86%	585.15	+0.59%
Rotation destination	Defense innovation / tactical defense beta	DFEN	5.26%	-7.25%	-1.45%	-8.64%	+5.19%	286.07	+0.29%
Rotation destination	Commodity-breadth hedge exposure	GSG	9.22%	+3.19%	+1.10%	-0.91%	-2.52%	-262.17	-0.26%
Rotation destination	Non-U.S. developed-market diversification	IEFA	24.05%	+0.54%	+0.45%	+1.74%	+1.21%	315.74	+0.32%
Real-asset capex	Grid and infrastructure capex	PAVE	0.03%	-0.09%	-2.89%	+1.98%	+9.11%	2.96	0.00%
Growth engine	AI compute / semiconductor leadership	SMH	28.13%	-2.89%	-7.12%	+27.40%	+42.89%	9,307.88	+9.31%
Core beta	Core U.S. large-cap exposure	SPY	0.03%	+0.69%	+1.44%	+8.35%	+11.16%	3.04	0.00%
Strategic energy	Nuclear and uranium cycle exposure	URNM	7.01%	-2.55%	-8.34%	-24.69%	-23.57%	-2,382.09	-2.38%
Rotation destination	Defensive utilities / rate-sensitive ballast	XLU	5.40%	+0.46%	+2.99%	-1.31%	+6.00%	336.96	+0.34%

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Analyst Report

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ASSET ALLOCATION MAP

Bucket	Stance	Reason
US equities	Neutral	Investable but concentration risk is explicit.
Europe equities	Neutral	IEFA now provides non-U.S. developed-market exposure, but broader allocation still requires relative-strength confirmation.
EM equities	Underweight	USD and oil sensitivity remain headwinds.
large cap	Neutral	Quality leadership still works.
small cap	Underweight	Rates and refinancing remain difficult.
growth	Neutral	Selective growth led by SMH remains attractive.
quality	Overweight	Earnings durability remains valuable.
defensive ballast	Neutral	Hedge and cash-like roles remain under opportunity-cost review.
industrials / defense	Overweight	Structural thesis valid; vehicle under review.
non-USD assets	Watchlist	IEFA now provides non-U.S. developed-market exposure, but broader allocation still requires relative-strength confirmation.

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SECOND-ORDER EFFECTS MAP

Driver	First-order effect	Second-order effect	Likely beneficiaries	Likely losers	ETF implication	Timing	Confidence
AI leadership	SMH remains the cleanest growth expression	Concentration must be watched	SMH , SOXX	Lower-quality cyclicals	Hold near max size	Immediate	High
Factor concentration	SPY and SMH overlap	Portfolio is less diversified than ticker count suggests	QUAL , IEFA watchlist	Overlapping U.S. beta	Keep SPY under review	1-3 months	Medium
Defense thesis vs ETF implementation	Defense remains structurally valid	PPA must justify itself versus ITA	ITA , PPA	Weak vehicle selection	Hold PPA under review	Immediate	Medium
Hedge drawdown	Hedge role must be proven	GSG/BIL remain challengers	GSG , BIL , cash	Unproductive hedge	Hold hedge sleeve under review	Immediate	Medium

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CURRENT POSITION REVIEW

Ticker	Action	Score	Fresh cash	Role	Required next action
CIBR	Hold	4.97	Hold / monitor	Rotation destination	Release score 10.00. Monitor relative strength and portfolio concentration.
DFEN	Hold	3.10	No / under review	Rotation destination	Release score 50.00. Review defense vehicle fit versus ITA/PPA and leverage constraints.
GSG	Hold	3.59	Hold / monitor	Rotation destination	Release score 10.00. Monitor commodity breadth and hedge contribution after execution.
IEFA	Hold	3.52	Hold / monitor	Rotation destination	Release score 10.00. Monitor non-U.S. breadth and SPY-relative performance.
PAVE	Hold with override	3.68	Smaller / under review	Real-asset capex	Release score 85.00. Force alternative duel; upgrade, reduce, replace, or close
SMH	Hold	4.28	Smaller / under review	Growth engine	Release score 60.00. Force alternative duel; upgrade, reduce, replace, or close
SPY	Hold with override	3.53	Smaller / under review	Core beta	Release score 85.00. Force alternative duel; upgrade, reduce, replace, or close
URNM	Hold	3.70	Hold	Strategic energy	Release score 0.00. Hold
XLU	Hold	3.00	No / under review	Rotation destination	Release score 50.00. Review defensive ballast role versus BIL/SHV and opportunity cost.

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BEST NEW OPPORTUNITIES

- [SMH](#) remains the best earned exposure, but no fresh capital is added while it is above the 25% max-position cap.
- [XBI](#) / [IBB](#): Biotech remains a long-duration innovation lane but needs risk appetite.
- [XLV](#) / [VHT](#): Healthcare quality can provide defensive growth without speculative biotech beta.
- [XLU](#) / [VPU](#): AI data-center power demand can also support regulated utilities and transmission spend.
- Replacement candidates remain evidence-gated: pricing basis and duel status must be visible before funding.

4B

REPLACEMENT DUEL TABLE

Current holding	Challenger	1m edge	3m edge	Pricing basis	Decision	Required trigger
SPY	IWM	-0.69%	+1.49%	Current and challenger closes validated on 2026-07-14 / 2026-07-14.	Challenger improving; keep duel active.	Needs repeat 3m edge and capital source.
SPY	QUAL	-0.40%	-0.53%	Current and challenger closes validated on 2026-07-14 / 2026-07-14.	Current holding still leads; no replacement.	Needs sustained relative outperformance.
SPY	EFA	-0.98%	-6.56%	Current and challenger closes validated on 2026-07-14 / 2026-07-14.	Current holding still leads; no replacement.	Needs sustained relative outperformance.
SPY	IEFA	-0.99%	-6.61%	Current and challenger closes validated on 2026-07-14 / 2026-07-14.	Current holding still leads; no replacement.	Needs sustained relative outperformance.
PAVE	GRID	-1.31%	-2.07%	Current and challenger closes validated on 2026-07-14 / 2026-07-14.	Current holding still leads; no replacement.	Needs sustained relative outperformance.
URNM	URA	-3.41%	+0.71%	Current and challenger closes validated on 2026-07-14 / 2026-07-14.	Challenger improving; keep duel active.	Needs repeat 3m edge and capital source.

Current holding	Challenger	1m edge	3m edge	Pricing basis	Decision	Required trigger
SMH	SOXX	-2.17%	+7.40%	Current and challenger closes validated on 2026-07-14 / 2026-07-14.	Replacement trigger watch - challenger leading over 3m.	Confirm thesis fit, liquidity and funding source.
PAVE	XLU	+5.88%	-3.29%	Current and challenger closes validated on 2026-07-14 / 2026-07-14.	Early 1m improvement only; wait for 3m confirmation.	Needs 3m confirmation.

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PORTFOLIO ROTATION PLAN

Close	Reduce	Hold	Hold with override	Add / destination	Replace
None	None	SMH , DFEN , XLU , CIBR , GSG , IEFA , URNM	PAVE , SPY	None	None

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FINAL ACTION TABLE

Weight basis note: action-table weights are model/action weights; current-holdings weights are live market-value weights including cash. Small differences can occur when cash, rounding or override handling is included.

Hold-with-override note: The model would normally force reduce/replace review, but the position is too small or operationally impractical to trade this run.

Ticker	ETF	Current weight	Target weight	Delta weight	Action	Capital destination	Release score	Decision rationale	Override status
CIBR	CIBR	18.40	18.40	0.00	Hold	-	10.00	Role under review	No
DFEN	DFEN	5.93	5.93	0.00	Hold	-	50.00	Position does not pass the fresh-capital test; A stronger alternative is available for comparison; Role under review	No
GSG	GSG	8.43	8.43	0.00	Hold	-	10.00	Role under review	No

Ticker	ETF	Current weight	Target weight	Delta weight	Action	Capital destination	Release score	Decision rationale	Override status
IEFA	IEFA	23.88	23.88	0.00	Hold	-	10.00	Role under review	No
PAVE	Global X U.S. Infrastructure Development ETF	0.03	0.03	0.00	Hold with override	-	85.00	Fresh capital only after review or at smaller size; Position is under replacement review; Review has persisted for multiple report cycles; Review has persisted for several report...	System override: Minimum trade size was not met
SMH	VanEck Semiconductor ETF	29.12	29.12	0.00	Hold	-	60.00	Fresh capital only after review or at smaller size; Position is under replacement review; Review has persisted for multiple report cycles; Role under review	No
SPY	SPDR S&P 500 ETF Trust	0.03	0.03	0.00	Hold with override	-	85.00	Fresh capital only after review or at smaller size; Position is under replacement review; Review has persisted for multiple report cycles; Review has persisted for several report...	System override: Minimum trade size was not met
URNM	Sprott Uranium Miners ETF	7.12	7.12	0.00	Hold	-	0.00	-	No
XLU	XLU	5.30	5.30	0.00	Hold	-	50.00	Position does not pass the fresh-capital test; A stronger alternative is available for comparison; Role under review	No



POSITION CHANGES REFLECTED IN OFFICIAL STATE

Source	Destination	Source delta %	Destination delta %	Estimated notional EUR	Intent status	Rationale
None	None	0.00	0.00	0.00	No proposed rotation	No actionable rotation proposal was generated this run.

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CURRENT PORTFOLIO HOLDINGS AND CASH

- Starting capital (EUR): 100000.00
- Invested market value (EUR): 108288.33
- Cash (EUR): 1936.52
- Total portfolio value (EUR): 110224.85
- Since inception return (%): 10.22
- EUR/USD used: 1.1421

Ticker	Shares	Price (local)	Currency	Market value (local)	Market value (EUR)	Weight %
CIBR	253.94	94.73	USD	24055.40	21062.24	19.11
DFEN	91.77	72.19	USD	6624.73	5800.43	5.26
GSG	374.29	31.00	USD	11603.09	10159.35	9.22
IEFA	312.49	96.89	USD	30277.02	26509.72	24.05
PAVE	0.71	56.71	USD	40.51	35.47	0.03
SMH	59.00	600.31	USD	35418.29	31011.28	28.13
SPY	0.05	751.83	USD	34.60	30.29	0.03
URNM	171.00	51.59	USD	8821.89	7724.20	7.01
XLU	148.87	45.69	USD	6801.67	5955.35	5.40
CASH	-	1.00	EUR	1936.52	1936.52	1.76

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CONTINUITY INPUT FOR NEXT RUN

Portfolio table

Ticker	ETF Name	Direction	Weight %	Avg Entry	Current Price	P/L %	Original Thesis	Role
CIBR	CIBR	Long	19.11		94.73			Rotation destination
DFEN	DFEN	Long	5.26		72.19			Rotation destination
GSG	GSG	Long	9.22	31.80	31.00		Rotation destination	Rotation destination
IEFA	IEFA	Long	24.05		96.89			Rotation destination
PAVE	Global X U.S. Infrastructure Development ETF	Long	0.03	51.98	56.71	8.25	Grid and infrastructure capex	Real-asset capex
SMH	VanEck Semiconductor ETF	Long	28.13	420.13	600.31	20.61	AI compute / semiconductor leadership	Growth engine
SPY	SPDR S&P 500 ETF Trust	Long	0.03	676.33	751.83	6.17	Core U.S. large-cap exposure	Core beta
URNM	Sprott Uranium Miners ETF	Long	7.01	67.50	51.59	-0.55	Nuclear and uranium cycle exposure	Strategic energy
XLU	XLU	Long	5.40		45.69			Rotation destination

Available cash

- Cash %: 1.76
- Margin usage %: 0.00
- Leverage allowed: No

Watchlist / dynamic radar memory

Theme	Primary ETF	Alternative ETF	Why I'm considering it	Current status
AI compute infrastructure	SMH	SOXX	Strongest secular growth exposure.	Active / capped
Defense innovation / sovereign resilience	PPA	ITA	Defense thesis valid but vehicle under review.	Duel required
Grid buildout / electrification	PAVE	GRID	Infrastructure capex remains valid.	Duel required
Commodity-breadth hedge review	GSG	DBC / BIL	Current commodity-breadth hedge role must be proven against cash and broad commodity alternatives.	Under review
Non-U.S. developed diversification	IEFA	EFA	IEFA now provides non-U.S. developed-market exposure, with broader allocation still under confirmation.	Watchlist

Recommendation discipline continuity

- Rotation execution: active.
- Replacement challengers: not fundable without completed duel.

Constraints

- Max position size: 25% soft cap; current inherited overweights require no-fresh-cash and review/trim discipline
- Max number of positions: 8 soft target; current inherited count may exceed this until guarded rotation reduces it
- UCITS only: No
- Leverage ETFs allowed: No
- Drawdown tolerance: Moderate
- Income vs growth preference: Balanced growth with resilience bias

Changes since last review

- Added: runtime-rendered markdown generation layer.
- Reduced: None unless explicit state says otherwise.
- Closed: None.
- Thesis changes: No structural thesis was abandoned; implementation, macro-regime and rotation discipline are materially tighter.

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